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August 21, 2020

Carlos Marquez
City of Huntington Beach
200 Main Street
Huntington Beach, CA 92648

Subject: Site Summary and Recommendations

Re: Beach Boulevard Property (APN 167-472-07)
17642 Beach Boulevard
Huntington Beach, CA 92647
OCHCA Case #20IC002

BACKGROUND

The project site (Site) is a 0.79 acre unpaved vacant lot in an area of mixed commercial and residential use. The Site is bounded by commercial properties to the south, Beach Boulevard to the west, Cameron Lane to the east, and the Cameron Ln. Property located at 17631 Cameron Lane (Cameron Ln Property) to the north. The Site and the Cameron Ln Property are both part of the current site development project and Orange County Health Care Agency (OCHCA) Industrial Cleanup Case No. 20IC002 (see attached Site Summary and Recommendations letter). The future planned use of the Site is an asphalt-paved lot with a large tent structure to provide temporary shelter for people experiencing homelessness, as ordered by the Governor's Executive Order N-32-20, issued by Governor Newsom on March 18, 2020. This Site is a continuation of the Cameron Ln. Property. Investigations of the Site were conducted by EEC Environmental (EEC) in several phases to assess the presence of contaminants that may have impacted the Site.

Contaminants of concern found in soil at the Site were hexavalent chromium and lead. On July 6, 2020, OCHCA was contacted by the City of Huntington Beach requesting OCHCA review of EECs June 25, 2020 Site Assessment Report for the Site referenced above. On April 27, 2020 the City of Huntington Beach entered into a Remedial Action Agreement with the OCHCA for oversight at the Cameron Ln. Property. On July 17, 2020 the City of Huntington Beach entered into a revised Remedial Action Agreement that included the Cameron Lane Property and the above referenced Site (Case No. 20IC002). As such OCHCA has prepared this Site Summary and Recommendations for the Site.

SITE INVESTIGATION

According to EEC's March 2020 Phase I report, the Site consists of two former single family residential homes, one irrigation well (OCWD well number W-4150/State well number 05S/11W-25M09), a cesspool that was abandoned in place and indicated past row crop agricultural use from the 1930s to the 1950s. Additionally, the Phase I report noted potential buried debris at the Site based on uneven topography. Subsurface investigations of the Site were conducted from April 14, 2020 through July 21, 2020. A total of seventeen soil borings (B19 through B25, B33 through B40, B19-A and B22-A) were advanced throughout the Site at depths ranging from 0.5 to 15 feet (ft) below ground surface (bgs). Select soil samples were submitted for analysis of Title 22 Metals (metals) including hexavalent chromium, organochlorine pesticides (OCPs), mercury, volatile organic compounds (VOCs), semi-VOCs, and total petroleum hydrocarbons (TPH). Samples with contaminant concentrations that exceeded screening levels¹ were found at the Site. Lead was detected in soil samples from soil boring locations B22, B33 and B35 with a maximum concentration detected at 145 milligrams per kilograms (mg/kg) near one of the the former single family residential home. Hexavalent chromium was detected in soil samples from boring locations B19, B36, B37, and B38 with a maximum concentrations detected at 450 ug/kg (B38 at 5 ft bgs). All other analytes were below background and current screening levels².

POTENTIAL DEBRIS EXPLORATION AND EXCAVATION

A geophysical survey was conducted at the Site by SubSurface Surveys, under the supervision of a State Registered Geophysicist, on April 13, 2020. Based the geophysical survey, two areas of potential buried debris were identified. On July 22, 2020 limited investigation excavations with areas of approximately 8 ft by 7 ft by 2 ft deep were conducted under OCHCA oversight. A buried metal fence and old sewer pipe was discovered in one area of concern. Small pieces of metal debris were found in the second area of concern. No evidence of contamination was found during this investigation. Excavated soil was placed back in the small excavations and debris was left onsite for future disposal. The geophysical survey report erroneously indicates the site address as 17631 Cameron Lane in Huntington Beach, however, figure 3 and photographs 1 through 10 show the survey was conducted on the property at 17642 Beach Boulevard. The purpose of the geophysical survey was to locate and identify the existence of any underground storage tanks (USTs), backfilled excavations, piping, conduit, and other buried features that may exist within the survey area. Several inactive buried utility lines and areas with buried metal debris were identified across the site. However, no buried features were detected in the southeast corner of the site, where records indicate that a groundwater production well (State Well Number 05S/11W-25M09) had been located.

¹ USEPA, Region 9, Regional Screening Levels (residential exposure scenario), May 2020; Department of Toxic Substances Control Human and Ecological Risk Assessment (HHRA), Note 3, June 2020, University of California, Kearney Foundation for Soil Science, Background Concentrations of Trace and Major Elements in California Soils, March 1996.

² ² Ibid.

Table 1 – Nature & Degree of Site Contamination

Contaminant	Maximum Site Detection and Sample Identification	Regulatory Screening Level ³ (Residential Scenario)
Lead	145 mg/kg B33-0.5	DTSC Hero Note 3r- 80 mg/kg
Hexavalent Chromium	450 ug/kg B38-0.5	DTSC Hero Note 3r- 300 ug/kg

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

Several phases of investigation were conducted at the Site, results of which showed the presence of lead and hexavalent chromium in excess of site screening levels. Based on OCHCAs review of the information noted above, soil impacts located beneath the proposed asphalt cover are not considered to be a threat to the occupants of the temporary tent structure. Soil contamination however, must be addressed if changes to site use occur. Additional site assessment may also be required if changes to site use occur. It is the property owner's responsibility to notify this Agency if there is any change in site use and/or if there are future findings of additional contamination at the Site. Additionally, any excavated soil for tent structure installation must be managed, handled, and disposed of properly, in accordance with all regulatory requirements to minimize exposure to workers and the community. If the irrigation well that had been installed in the southeast corner of the Site is encountered during grading or excavation, a well destruction permit must be obtained from this office.

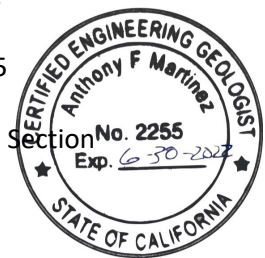
If you have any questions regarding this matter, please contact the undersigned at (714) 433-6251.

Sincerely,

Tamara Escobedo

Tamara Escobedo
Engineering Geologist
Hazardous Materials Mitigation Section
Environmental Health Division


Anthony F. Martinez, EG #2255
Program Manager
Hazardous Material Mitigation Section
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cc: Health Care Agency
David Ahern, OC Public Works
David Bernier EEC

³ Ibid